



Gamma RP

1st Edition

A simple roleplaying system meant to be dynamic and expansible

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Contents

1	Introduction	1
I	The System	3
2	The Basics	5
2.1	Dice Rolling Basics	5
2.2	Modifying Rolls	6
2.2.1	Bonus and Penalty Dice	7
2.2.2	Additional Advantage and Disadvantage	7
2.3	Group Rolls	7
2.4	Roll Contests	8
2.5	Helping Rolls	9
3	Building a Character	11
3.1	Fundamental Attributes	11
3.1.1	Talent Proxying	13
3.1.2	Depleting Fundamentals	14
3.2	Wounds	15
3.2.1	Injuries	15
3.3	Species Bonuses	15
3.4	Archetypes	15
3.5	Loadout Overview	16
3.5.1	Casts	16
3.5.2	Augments	17
3.5.3	Equipment	17
3.5.4	Changing Loadout	18
3.6	Languages	18
3.7	Skills	18
3.8	Character Building Overview	19
	Character Sheet	21
4	Gameplay	23
4.1	Open mode	23
4.1.1	Taking Damage	25
4.1.2	Downtime	25
4.2	Phased mode	27
4.2.1	The Arena	28
4.2.2	Ranges	30
4.2.3	Offense	30
4.2.4	Defense	32

II	The Setting	33
5	Overview of the Gamma Nebula	35
5.1	A brief history	35
6	The Physics of Gamma Nebula	37
6.1	Elements	37
6.1.1	Base Element	37
6.1.2	The Motive Elements	37
6.1.3	Transformative Elements	37
6.1.4	Primary Elements	38
6.1.5	Noble Elements	38
6.1.6	Higher Elements	38
7	Races	39
7.1	Wyrmlkin	40
7.2	Kobolds	41
7.3	Carcinids	42
7.4	Automa	43
7.5	Species template	44
III	Appendices	45
	Mathematical Formulas	47
	List of Figures	49
	List of Tables	51
	Alphabetical Index	53

Introduction

Gamma RP, or ΓRP, is a tabletop role-playing game (TTRPG) system meant to strike a balance between pure theater-of-the-mind systems and map based tabletop systems.

I've found that the most engaging TTRPG systems for me were ones that had a visual element, but these by necessity often put a lot of burden of preparation on the moderator(s) of the game. They also can indirectly limit the amount of improvisation possible by the players since the moderator needs to prepare visual assets based on what the players choose, and this slows down the game.

It also takes time away from world-building.

For me, the motivation for being the moderator (or game master, dungeon master, etc.) of a TTRPG is to build a world that my players can explore, interact with, and build characters and parts of the world themselves. I needed a system where any maps, items, or enemies could be very quickly created from scratch on-the-fly by an untrained game master.

So, faced with my perpetual scarcity of free time, I naturally decided to spend a few years creating ΓRP and the Gamma Nebula Setting before actually sitting down and playing with my friends.

The ΓRP system and the Gamma Nebula Setting are separated into different sections of this rulebook. The base system of rules is meant to be easy to build on top of, but the Gamma Nebula Setting is the setting that I initially built it for. Given how much work I've put into both, I am of the mind to release them together for anyone else that may want to use the pre-built setting.

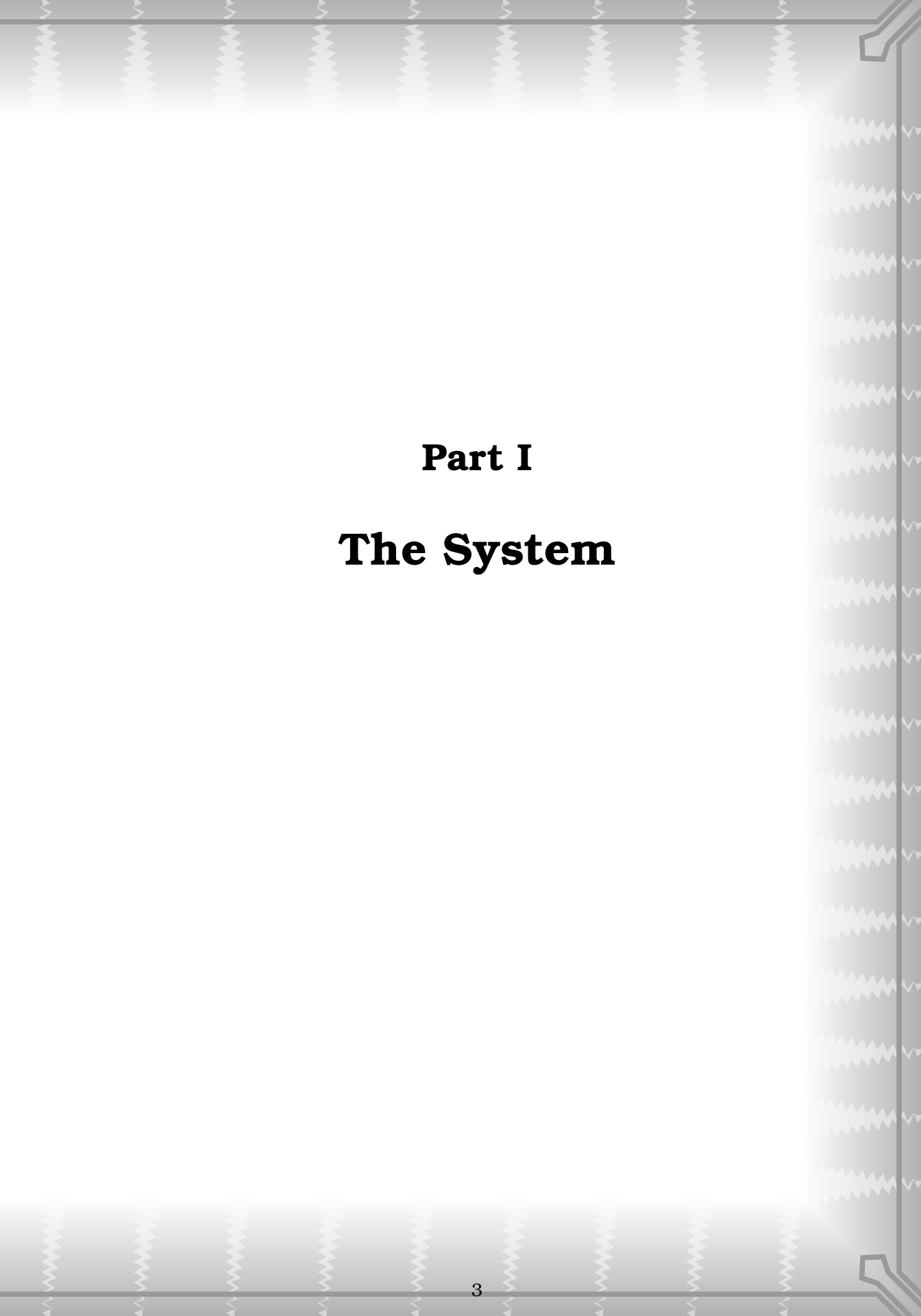
I heavily encourage any users of this system to build their own settings on top of this system.

I need to make this introduction more sensible and legible, but for now this placeholder will suffice!

Enjoy!

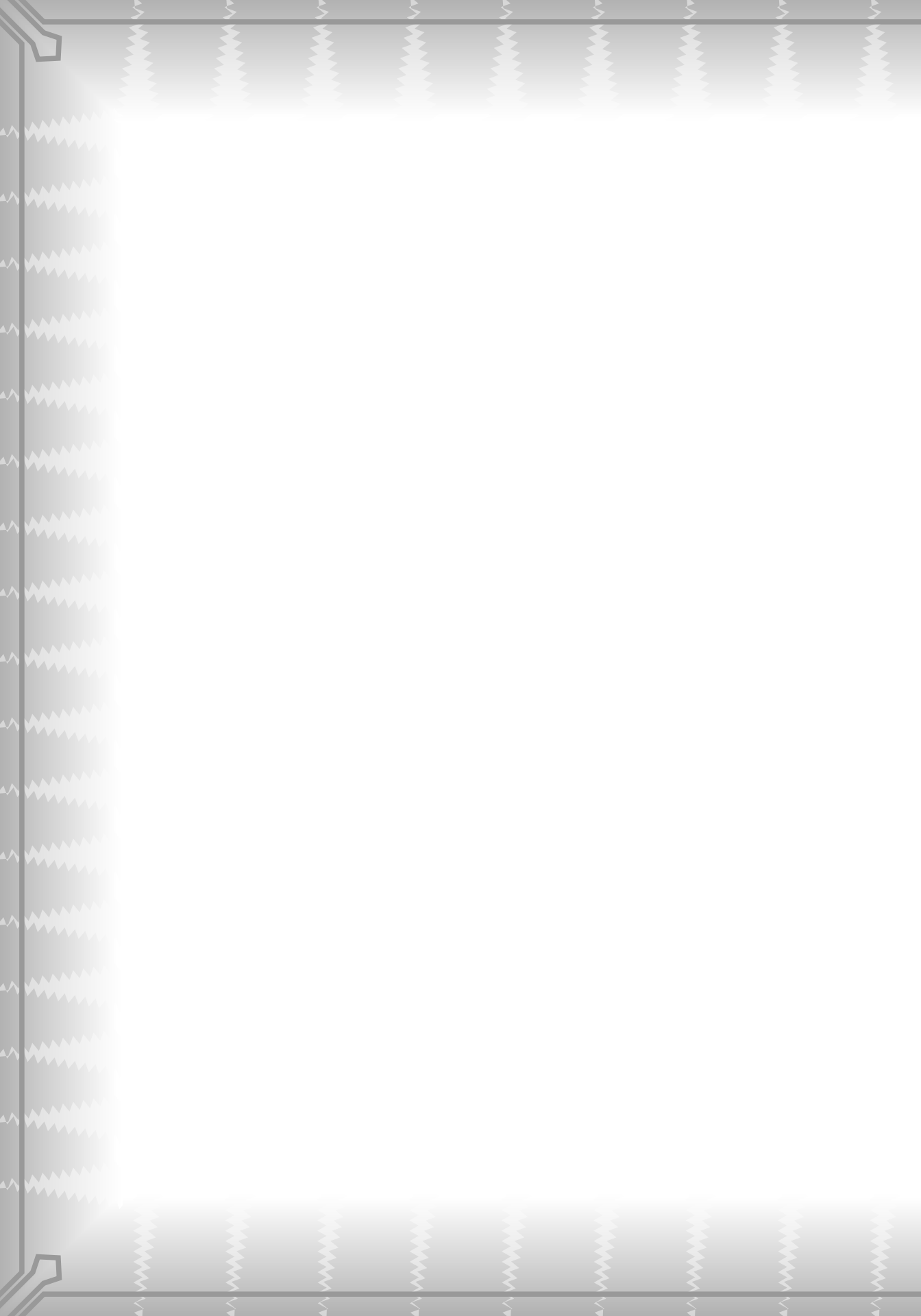
Here is a purely tikz generated logo attempt:

Gamma RP, or  ΓRP is so cool that I use it to preserve food in my refrigerator



Part I

The System



2 The Basics

TRP is a tabletop role-playing game. This is a specific class of improvisational acting game in which the participants are divided into *Game Masters* (often referred to as GM's) and *Players*. Most games will require at least one game master in order to play the game, and the game master and players work together to tell a story.

The Game Master is responsible for constructing the world around the Players, and giving the players a setting to interact with. The Players are responsible for maintaining a Player Character—a character who interacts with and influences the setting defined by the Game Master.

Since the game is collaborative in this way, it is more fun and fair if there is an element of chance in deciding how a scene unfolds. TRP uses the roll of a set of dice to decide whether an unsure course of action is successful.



The fundamental dice mechanic in TRP is based on 12 sided dice, and rolls several at a time. If you intend to play the game on a real physical tabletop (rather than one of the increasingly popular virtual ones), you may want to obtain at least a dozen 12 sided dice for convenience. It is possible to play with fewer dice by rolling one die at a time.

2.1 Dice Rolling Basics

The notation for a roll in TRP is written as $RXaY$, which verbally is pronounced as “Roll X a Y ”

- X is the number of dice you roll.

- Y is the *advantage* on the roll, which indicates that the top Y numbers of a die pass the success threshold.

If any of the dice you roll pass the success threshold, then your roll is a success.

The quickest way to judge if your advantaged roll is a success is:

1. Add the advantage to the value of each die in your roll
2. If $[\text{ADVANTAGE}] + [\text{DIE VALUE}] > 12$ for any die in your roll, your roll is a success.

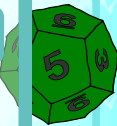
An advantage of 0 is the exception to this: $RXa0$ is still successful if any of the dice roll a 12. Both larger X and larger Y indicate a higher probability of success.



Let's look at a few example rolls.

Table 2a: Advantage Examples

ROLL	DICE	RESULT
R5a1	① ① ① ⑧ ④ ⑩	FAILURE
R5a1	① ① ② ⑫ ②	SUCCESS
R4a1	① ① ⑧ ⑩	FAILURE
R4a2	① ⑪ ⑧ ⑩	SUCCESS
R4a3	① ⑪ ⑧ ⑩	SUCCESS
R3a3	① ⑨ ⑧	FAILURE
R3a4	① ⑨ ⑧	SUCCESS
R3a8	② ④ ③	FAILURE
R3a9	② ④ ③	SUCCESS



Advantage can also be negative. For convenience this is written as *disadvan-*

tage which is the negative of the advantage. A roll of $RXa(-Z)$ is written equivalently as $RXdZ$.

For a roll at *disadvantage* of Z to be successful, in addition to having at least one die in the roll land on 12, there must also be at least Z dice within the roll displaying a number above 1.

The quickest way to judge if your disadvantaged roll is a success is:

- 1. Check if there are any dice showing 12 in your roll
- 2. Count the number of dice that show a value above 1
- 3. If $[NUMBER\ OF\ DICE\ ABOVE\ 1] > [DISADVANTAGE]$ for *any* die in your roll, and there is at least one die showing 12, your roll is a success.

Note that the rolls $RXa1$, $RXa0$, and $RXd1$ are all actually identical, with all three requiring a single dice of the set to result 12 in order to result a success.

Lets look at a few example disadvantage rolls.

Table 2b: Disadvantage Examples

ROLL	DICE	RESULT
R2d1	12 ₁ 2 ₂	SUCCESS
R2d1	12 ₁ 1 ₁	SUCCESS
R2d2	12 ₁ 1 ₁	FAILURE
R4d1	11 8 1 10	FAILURE
R4d2	12 ₁ 8 ₂ 1 10 ₃	SUCCESS
R4d3	12 ₁ 8 ₂ 1 10 ₃	SUCCESS
R4d4	12 ₁ 8 ₂ 1 10 ₃	FAILURE
R8d7	12 ₁ 12 ₂ 1 12 ₃ 12 ₄ 12 ₅ 12 ₆ 1	FAILURE

When the disadvantage is greater than or equal to the number of dice being rolled, the roll is an automatic failure even if you have at least one dice showing a 12. If you are asked to make a roll with a disadvantage equal to or greater than the number of dice, you may simply declare a failure. However you may still make the roll if you have abilities that benefit from actually rolling the dice.

Table 2c: Probability of success for various rolls

$RXAY$	$RXd6$	$RXd5$	$RXd4$	$RXd3$	$RXd2$	$RXd1$	$RXa0$	$RXa1$	$RXa2$	$RXa3$	$RXa4$	$RXa5$	$RXa6$	$RXa7$
R1aY	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	8.3%	8.3%	8.3%	16.7%	25.0%	33.3%	41.7%	50.0%	58.3%
R2aY	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	15.3%	16.0%	16.0%	16.0%	30.6%	43.8%	55.6%	66.0%	75.0%	82.6%
R3aY	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	20.4%	21.6%	23.0%	23.0%	23.0%	42.1%	57.8%	70.4%	80.2%	87.5%	92.8%
R4aY	0.0%	0.0%	24.0%	25.7%	27.5%	29.4%	29.4%	29.4%	51.8%	68.4%	80.2%	88.4%	93.8%	97.0%
R5aY	0.0%	26.4%	28.4%	30.5%	32.8%	35.3%	35.3%	35.3%	59.8%	76.3%	86.8%	93.2%	96.9%	98.7%
R6aY	27.9%	30.1%	32.5%	35.0%	37.7%	40.7%	40.7%	40.7%	66.5%	82.2%	91.2%	96.1%	98.4%	99.5%

2.2 Modifying Rolls

Very often a character will have a default way they roll something in a situation, but the circumstances of the situation impair or improve their chances of suc-

cess.

When this happens, it is often easier as a GM to specify the roll they must make as a modification of the dice or advantage of their usual roll.

2.2.1 Bonus and Penalty Dice

You should only modify the number of dice for a characters sparingly or if the rulebook specifies that you should do so. Modifying the number of dice is described using the terms “die bonus” and “die penalty”.

If the rules specify you take a W die penalty- then you roll with W fewer dice than you ordinarily would. Die Penalties are abbreviated with $\{-W\}$, for instance- if you see $\{-2\}$ after a roll, it means you take a 2 die penalty to that roll.

If the rules specify you take a X die bonus- then you roll with X more dice than you ordinarily would. Die Bonuses are abbreviated with $\{+X\}$, for instance- if you see $\{+2\}$ after a roll, it means you have a 2 die bonus to that roll.

2.2.2 Additional Advantage and Disadvantage

Modifying the advantage and disadvantage on a roll may be done more freely by the GM than adding dice bonuses or penalties. If the situation is harder than usual, the GM may impose “additional disadvantage” on the players. If the situation has been modified to be easier than usual, the GM may grant “additional advantage” to the players.

If the GM or the rules specify you take Y additional advantage- then you roll with Y higher advantage than you ordinarily would. Additional Advantage is often abbreviated with $\{aaY\}$, for instance- if you see $\{aa2\}$ after a roll, it means you roll with 2 additional advantage.

If the GM or the rules specify you take Z additional disadvantage- then you roll with Z lower advantage than you ordinarily would. Remember that $-Z$ advantage is the same as Z disadvantage. Rolling with additional disadvantage may still leave some net advantage to the roll left over. Additional disadvantage is often abbreviated with $\{ddZ\}$, for instance-

if you see $\{dd2\}$ after a roll, it means you roll with 2 additional disadvantage.

2.3 Group Rolls

Sometimes multiple characters must all individually perform the same task, in a way where their average performance impacts the success of the group. This often happens in situations where one character could catch another character if they fail, by performing well enough. Such a situation calls for a Group Roll.

The process of a Group Roll is as follows:

1. Each character making a Group Roll makes the corresponding roll for the task
2. Count the total number of successes among the group
3. If $[\text{TOTAL SUCCESSES}] \geq [\text{GROUP SIZE}]$ then the group succeeds at the roll.

If you need to count the number of successes for a Group Roll, it is $[\text{TOTAL SUCCESSES}]/[\text{GROUP SIZE}]$ rounded **down** to the nearest whole number.

This may be most easily illustrated with an example.

GM: As you enter the swamp, the mud grows deeper and harder to trudge through. You'll all have to use your Fortitude talent to pass without hurting yourselves.

Alice: Can we make this a Group Roll? I think we could catch each other if we fall.

GM: Absolutely. Make a Group Roll for **88 FORTITUDE**.

FORTITUDE GROUP ROLL

Bob: R2a3 - 8 3

Alice: R5a5 - 1 8 2 5 10

(continued...)

(...continued)

Eve: R6a4 - ③ ⑦ ⑫ ④ ① ②**GM:** Great. Between all of you you have 3 successes. Alice's extra success makes up for Bob's lack of success.

Bob- you stumble in the thick mud and almost land face first, but Alice catches you. You all struggle through and make it through the swamp without injury.

Other examples of situations where group rolls are appropriate include:

- Stealthily getting through a stretch of terrain
- Persuading someone that your group is trustworthy
- A coordinated group performance of any kind
- Crafting a large batch of items or cooking a large meal

2.4 Roll Contests

Sometimes, one character may struggle against another character or entity within the game. When this happens, the game enters a roll contest—both characters roll against each other.

The process of a roll contest is as follows:

1. Both characters make their roll simultaneously.
2. If one character is successful and the other is not, the successful character wins.
3. If both characters are unsuccessful, return to step 1.

4. If both characters are successful, the first character will be penalized dice equal to the number of successes of the second character, and vice versa. Return to step 1.

5. If you have repeated this process to the point where one character has no dice remaining, the character who has dice remaining wins the contest.

6. If both characters reach 0 dice simultaneously, both characters lose the contest (taking any penalties involved with losing the contest).

Step 6 is only important when one of the characters has an ability that imposes a penalty for failing a roll.

Roll Contests are probably best illustrated with an example as follows.

Eve: Can I initiate a grapple on the guard?**GM:** Sure! Go ahead and initiate a Roll Contest with  **ATHLETICS**.**Eve:** I'll use my Dexterity talent since I'm much better at that.**GM:** Sure, you can *talent proxy*. Use Dexterity at 2 additional disadvantage.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 1

Eve: R6a2 - ③ ⑤ ⑨ ① ④ ⑤**Guard:** R4a4 - ② ⑧ ③ ②**Eve:** Shoot.**GM:** Don't worry, neither of you have any successes, so you'll roll again.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 2

Eve: R6a2 - ⑨ ⑪ ⑦ ② ⑥ ③**Guard:** R4a4 - ⑨ ① ③ ⑩

(continued...)

(...continued)

GM: You grab the guard but he's wriggling out of your grasp. You'll roll with 2 fewer dice since he got 2 successes, and he'll roll with 1 fewer dice because you got 1 success. Go again.

ROLL CONTEST ATTEMPT 3

Eve: R4a2 - 12 4 1 2

Guard: R3a4 - 4 7 3

Eve: Yes! I succeeded and the guard did not.

GM: Great! You deftly bend the guard's arm and twist him into your awaiting chokehold. You've grappled the guard.

It is highly disrecommended to perform a *Group Roll contest*. For tasks of that complexity it is usually better to let the game enter phased mode- which will be described in detail later.

If you do find yourself in a situation in which a Group Roll contest is called for, the process is as follows.

1. Both groups make their Group Rolls simultaneously..
2. If one group is successful and the other is not, the successful group wins.
3. If both groups are unsuccessful, return to step 1.
4. If both groups are successful, the first group must be penalized a number of dice equal to the second group's number of successes, and vice versa. Every character in the group takes this penalty. Then return to Step 1.
5. If you have repeated this process to the point where one group has no

dice remaining, the group who has dice remaining wins the contest.

6. If both groups reach 0 dice simultaneously, both groups lose the contest (taking any penalties involved with losing the contest).

2.5 Helping Rolls

Sometimes in a situation, a character may be able to help another character perform a task, such as lifting a heavy object, searching for insight into a puzzle, playing a game of chess, putting on a performance, or wrestling an opponent.

When this happens they may roll to help the other character. This is simpler than a Group Roll.

An helping roll is performed as follows:

1. Any character that is able to help and wants to help rolls the same talent or ability as the character making the initial roll.
2. The sum of all participating characters' successes, including the original character, is the number of successes for the original roll.
3. If the roll risks injury on failure, all of the participating characters will receive the injury.

Below is an example of a helping roll.

GM: Large Larry is the only one left, and he is *obstructing* the exit to this room. Player party, it's your offensive phase.

Eve: I'm so done with this fight. Can I just cast telekinesis and shove him out of the way?

Bob: I also have telekenesis. I can help!

(continued...)

(...continued)

GM: Great, this will be a roll contest between Eve and Large Larry, with Bob helping Eve. Both of you give me your telekinesis rolls and Larry will contest with fortitude.

ROLL CONTEST ROUND 1

Eve: R4a4 - 9 3 4 9

Bob: R4a3 - 5 11 10 10

Large: R6a5 - 7 2 1 12 9 1

Larry

GM: Nice rolls. Larry will take $\{-5\}$ next round, Bob and Eve will both take $\{-3\}$ next round.

ROLL CONTEST ROUND 2

Eve: R1a4 - 9

Bob: R1a3 - 4

Large: R1a5 - 4

Larry

GM: Excellent work. You push Larry out of the way and he is no longer obstructing the exit.

Note that this was a helping roll used in a roll contest. In round 2, both Bob and Eve took the penalty from Larry's successes in round 1, but Larry took the penalties from both Bob and Eve's successes in round 1.

When helping rolls are used for abilities other than base talents, the helping character must in general have and actively use the same ability as the character they are helping.

For instance, to help another character cast a particular spell, the helping character must know the same spell and use the same cast and consume a cast use.

In order to help another character use a specific augment ability, the helping character must have the same augment active in their loadout and use the same ability.

Additionally, to help a character in phased mode who is using an ability that takes an action (offensive or defensive), the helping character must also consume an action to help.

3 Building a Character

The same character building process is used for non-player-characters (NPC's) and player characters (PC's). This chapter will indicate when something is nonessential for a non-player character.

For a step by step overview of the process of building a character, consider skipping to Section 3.8.

3.1 Fundamental Attributes

All characters have 6 fundamental attributes, divided into 3 *Foundations* and 3 *Characteristics*.

- **Foundations**–
Mind, Body, Heart
- **Characteristics**–
Precision, Strength, Grace

The foundations and characteristics are combined to form 9 fundamental *talents* that all characters have.

Table 3a: Combining Foundations and Characteristics to get Talents

	PRECISION	STRENGTH	GRACE
MIND	MEMORY R[MIND]a[PRECISION]	INTELLECT R[MIND]a[STRENGTH]	INSIGHT R[MIND]a[GRACE]
BODY	DEXTERITY R[BODY]a[PRECISION]	FORTITUDE R[BODY]a[STRENGTH]	ATHLETICS R[BODY]a[GRACE]
HEART	PERCEPTION R[HEART]a[PRECISION]	WILL R[HEART]a[STRENGTH]	CHARISMA R[HEART]a[GRACE]

When building a character, you have:

- 6 points to distribute among your foundations ([**MIND**], [**BODY**], [**HEART**]) as you see fit
- 8 points to distribute among your characteristics ([**PRECISION**], [**STRENGTH**], [**GRACE**]) as you see fit

You **must** allocate at least 1 point to each foundation and each characteristic.

The number of points you allocate to each fundamental attribute become the

value of that fundamental attribute for the lifetime of your character and may not be changed after character creation.

However, you can gain aptitude in each of the fundamental talents which give additional advantage to their rolls, and racial bonuses and skills may give you bonus dice on different rolls.

The 12 fundamental talents are meant to intuitively follow from their construction. If you are trying to determine what talents are applicable in a situation, sim-

ply consider:

- Does this situation need Precision, Strength, or Grace?
- Does this situation relate to the Body, the Heart, or the Mind?

Then, find the corresponding row and column on the talent grid, and roll that talent to determine success.

The GM ultimately determines if a talent applies in a narrative situation, and

sometimes there may be more than one talent that is equally applicable. If the player can make an argument that the GM finds reasonable for why a talent is reasonable in a situation, they may roll that talent.

For clarity, what follows are descriptions of all the talents along with some example situations where they apply. This is not a comprehensive list.

• **MEMORY**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Mind, such as precise recall, exact pattern matching or recognition, or accurate calculation. Examples include:

- A character is trying to recall if they've seen a symbol before in their past
- A character is trying to determine which of two piles of material weighs more
- A character is trying to determine if a language or code they are hearing is one they've heard before.
- A character is trying to memorize instructions for a complex process

• **INTELLECT**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Mind– such as intense computation or decisions involving many simultaneous variables. Examples include:

- A character is trying to decode a coded message
- A character is coming up with the solution to a puzzle
- A character needs to beat another character in a game of chess

• **INSIGHT**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Mind, such as nimble thinking or problems requiring the right inspiration to strike in a timely manner. Examples include:

- A character is investigating a crime scene
- A character is trying to invent a mechanism to close a door based on objects strewn around the area
- A character is trying to discern the political motivations of an organization
- A character is trying to escape a trap or legal dilemma

• **DEXTERITY**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Body– think along the lines of quick and accurate reflexes. Examples include:

- Aiming a ranged weapon at a moving target

(continued...)

(...continued)

- Catching a rapidly moving small object
- Disarming a delicate trap without triggering it
- **FORTITUDE**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Body– think along the lines of endurance and raw physical power. Examples include:
 - Withstanding the effects of a strong alcoholic drink
 - Carrying a heavy object for a period of time
 - Wading through thick mud or pushing through tangled vines
- **ATHLETICS**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Body– think along the lines of well developed martial form or postural technique. Examples include:
 - Throwing an object as far as possible
 - Arm wrestling another character
 - Rolling out of a fall to mitigate damage
- **PERCEPTION**– Used for any situation that requires Precision of Heart. This applies to the accuracy of a character’s emotional inspiration. Examples include:
 - Determining if another character is lying
 - Accurately guessing why another character is acting strange
 - Figuring out what is meaningful to another character
- **WILL**– Used for any situation that requires Strength of Heart. This applies to determination and emotional centered-ness. Examples include:
 - A character is trying to withstand a psychic attack (or puppy-dog eyes)
 - A character is trying to power through pain to maintain focus on a task
 - A character is trying to resist the effects of a sedative
- **CHARISMA**– Used for any situation that requires Grace of Heart. This can be thought of the character’s ability to navigate emotional issues and convince other people to follow their lead. Examples include:
 - Persuading another character to give up an item
 - Rallying a crowd to perform an action
 - Deceiving another character about something

3.1.1 Talent Proxying

The various talents in ITRP have significant conceptual overlap. In addition to the GM determining what talents are appropriate to a situation, players are allowed to use talents on the opposite side

of the talent grid at 2 additional disadvantage. This is called talent proxying.

This encapsulates the fact that vastly different skills may be used to accomplish the same feat. For instance, the ability to remember details about what motivates people can substitute for the

ability to appeal to their emotions, and in this way, the **MEMORY** talent may proxy for the **CHARISMA** talent. Fast enough reflexes would allow you to adjust your body in the right way to accomplish martial feats that would usually require well developed form. Conversely, well developed form can substitute for fast and accurate reflexes. Therefore **DEXTERITY** and **ATHLETICS** can proxy for each other. **FORTITUDE** may be proxied with ei-

ther **INTELLECT**, **DEXTERITY**, **WILL**, or **ATHLETICS** at 4 additional disadvantage.

This represents the fact that physical problem solving (Intellect), accurate enough reflexes (Dexterity), dogged enough determination (Will), or well developed form (Athletics), can all substitute for raw power.

What follows are visual diagrams showing what talents can be proxied for others.

Figure 3a: Talents you can proxy at -2a

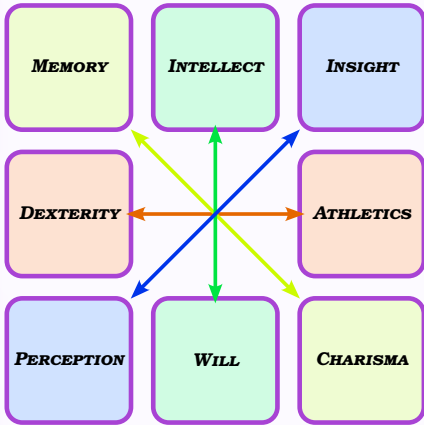
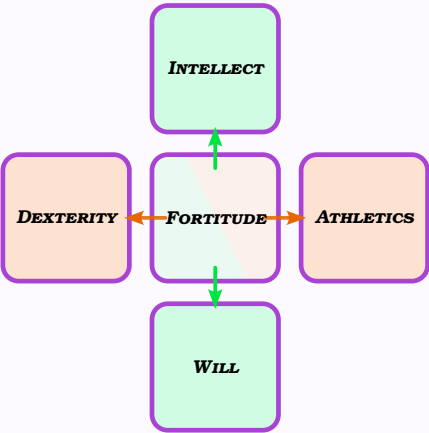


Figure 3b: Talents you can proxy at -4a



You can gain aptitude in your talents by spending experience points, or XP for short. Each aptitude gives 1 additional advantage when rolling the talent.

It costs:

- 1 XP for the first aptitude
- 2 XP for the second aptitude
- 3 XP for the third aptitude

You may have a maximum of 3 aptitude in any talent.

3.1.2 Depleting Fundamentals

In a pinch, you may *deplete* your foundations and your characteristics for certain bonuses.

Each time you *deplete* a fundamental, you incur an additional -1 penalty to that fundamental. This penalty persists until you next take the *sleep* downtime action. You may not deplete your foundations or characteristics below 0.

Note that if you deplete your **[MIND]**, **[BODY]**, or **[HEART]** to 0 you will **automatically fail all rolls related to these foundations**. You may still proxy a related talent to avoid failing the roll.

Depleting 2 foundations (**[MIND]**, **[BODY]**, or **[HEART]**) to 0 causes a character to fall *unconscious*. Your character may return to consciousness by having

one of their foundations restored.

Depleting all 3 foundations ([**MIND**], [**BODY**], and [**HEART**]) to 0, *kills* a character. If your character is dead- talents, abilities and items that normally restore foundation depletion will not work, and they must be restored to life by other means.

Any or all of a character's characteristics ([**PRECISION**], [**STRENGTH**], or [**GRACE**]) may be depleted to 0 without penalty.

3.2 Wounds

Each time a character receives a wound, they must choose a foundation ([**MIND**], [**BODY**], or [**HEART**]) to deplete by 1.

Healing wounds in this system is done by abilities that restore depleted foundations.

The **Robust** skill (described in Section 3.7) allows a character to take some wounds before depleting foundations.

3.2.1 Injuries

An injury is a specific type of wound which is applied directly to one specific foundation (one of [**MIND**], [**BODY**], or [**HEART**]).

The GM decides if a task has a risk of injury. Injuries are incurred specifically to the foundation related to the talent used for the failed task.

Failed **MEMORY**, **INTELLECT**, and **INSIGHT** rolls with a risk of injury result in an injury to [**MIND**].

Failed **DEXTERITY**, **FORTITUDE**, and **ATHLETICS** rolls with a risk of injury result in an injury to [**BODY**].

Failed **PERCEPTION**, **WILL**, and **CHARISMA** rolls with a risk of injury result in an injury to [**HEART**].

The Robust skill still protects you from injuries if you have wounds left that can be allocated to the Robust skill.

3.3 Species Bonuses

The species of a character provides bonuses to some of their talents.

The species bonuses are described for each species in Chapter ??.

3.4 Archetypes

Your character has an archetype- a way that their luck tends to run. This consists of a general type of *situation* and the type of *fortune* they have in this situation.

Your character starts with 1 archetype rank, and additional ranks may be added for 3 XP each. You may have a maximum of 5 archetype ranks.

You may choose to accumulate bonus archetype ranks above your usual maximum by *depleting* 1 from Grace for each bonus rank.

Situations:

- **Social**- all circumstances in which the character is trying to influence the actions or words of other characters in the world around them. Recieve +1 to [**GRACE**].
- **Technical**- all circumstances in which the character is trying to create or modify something in the world around them. Recieve +1 to [**PRECISION**].
- **Martial**- all circumstances in which the character is in combat or physical contest (with the environment or another player). Recieve +1 to [**STRENGTH**].

(continued...)

(...continued)

Fortunes:

- **Adept**– For any roll in your situation, you may adjust any die by up to [RANKS] values AFTER rolling.
- **Awkward**– Up to [RANKS] times a day, you may choose to automatically fail a roll in your situation in order to gain 4 bonus dice on your next roll (in any situation).
- **Confident**– Once a day, after making a successful roll in a situation, you may choose to gain 6 advantage for the next [RANKS] consecutive subsequent rolls in that situation. You must do this before seeing the results of any of the subsequent rolls.
- **Duplicitious**– When your character is in a contested roll in the situation, you may swap up to [RANKS] of your rolled dice with your opponent's rolled dice (even if your opponent is inanimate or the environment). Your number of successes still depend on how much advantage you had on your original roll, and your opponent's number of successes still depend on how much advantage they had in their original roll.
- **Judicious**– Roll [RANKS] dice at the beginning of the day. You maintain a pool of [RANKS] dice that starts initially populated by your first rolls. In any archetype situation- you may swap any number of dice in your pool with dice in your roll, AFTER seeing the result.
- **Lucky**– A number of times equal to your number of archetype ranks, you may choose to automatically succeed on a roll in this situation. You must choose to do this before seeing the result of the roll.
- **Oblivious**– Up to [RANKS] times a day in your character's situation, you may ignore a roll and force a reroll, AFTER seeing the result, and you may reverse decisions about whether you used another ability to alter the dice roll before rerolling it.

3.5 Loadout Overview

A character's *loadout* refers to the set of equipment and abilities that they currently have access to. In FRP these are split into three categories: Casts, Augments, and Equipment.

Since there are numerous options for each of the loadout categories, this section will simply describe the function of each loadout category without listing all the options. For more details on various loadout options, skip to Chapter ??.

For NPC's a GM may consider skipping fully defining a loadout. In most sit-

uations an NPC will function even if the loadout has sections that are not defined.

3.5.1 Casts

Casts are special abilities that may be used a limited number of times each day.

A character may only have a fixed number of *prepared casts*. On creation, a character's [MAX PREP] is equal to their [MIND] score. They may prep more casts than this by depleting their [MIND] score by 1 for each additional cast prepared. The [MIND] score depleted by overprepping casts may be restored by unprepping these casts.

In order to prepare a cast, a character must possess a cast focus corresponding to that cast. Most cast focuses are Wt 0 and cost 100 gold. Once a cast focus is in a character's possession it may be used as many times as desired to prepare that cast. A cast focus may be spell notes that a character has written themselves, or a series of runes that they use to imbue themselves with power, or even a device they activate which creates an effect on demand.

A character may only activate any of their prepared casts a fixed number of times between downtimes. On creation, a character's **[MAX CASTS]** is equal to their **[PRECISION]**.

To be clear, all of these cast activations may be due to the same cast being used, but a character may only cast a number of times equal to **[MAX CASTS]** without penalty. They may cast more than their usual max by depleting their **[PRECISION]** by 1 for each time they exceed **[MAX CASTS]**.

Options for casts in the base system are specified in Section ??.

3.5.2 Augments

Augments are devices, implants, or enhanced body features that grant a character extra abilities, which are powered by the intrinsic energy of the character's body or soul.

A character's **[MAX AUGMENTS]**, the number of augments they may have active without penalty, is initially equal to their **[HEART]** score. They may have more active augments than their **[MAX AUGMENTS]** by depleting their **[HEART]** score for one by every additional augment they keep active. The **[HEART]** score depleted by overactivating augments can be restored by deactivating augments over the limit.

Each augment in general gives a character access to one ability.

The exception is *attunements* which are special augments that give a char-

acter access to a skill tree that can be invested in with XP. Each attunement counts as **two** augments. Attunements can be very powerful but can be riskier if a character is *disabled* and has to deactivate an attunement, they will lose access to the entire skill tree provided by an augment.

Options for augments in the base system are specified in Section ??

3.5.3 Equipment

On creation, a character's **[EQUIP Wt]**, the total weight of equipment they can have actively equipped is equal to their **[BODY]** score. If a character equips equipment in excess of the **[EQUIP Wt]**, they will *deplete* their **[BODY]** score by 1 for each additional weight unit of equipment they equip. The **[BODY]** score depleted by overequipping equipment may be restored by unequipping the additional equipment.

Equipment is divided into armor and implements. Implements include weapons, tools, and accessories, as well as any other items that may need to be rapidly accessed, manipulated, or wielded during *phased* mode. A character may only have one piece of armor equipment actively equipped. A character may have any number of implweapons, tools and accessories actively equipped as long as the sum of their weights does not exceed the character's **[EQUIP Wt]**.

Only actively equipped items may be accessed without penalty when the game is in *phased* mode.

On creation, a character's **[PACK Wt]**, total weight of things they can have in their personal inventory (aside from equipment you currently have actively equipped) is equal to their **[STRENGTH]** score. Having more weight than this in their inventory will *deplete* their **[STRENGTH]** score by 1 for each additional weight unit of items they have in their inventory. The **[STRENGTH]** score depleted

by carrying too many items may be restored by dropping items in their inventory.

Options for equipment in the base system are specified in Section ??.

3.5.4 Changing Loadout

If you change your loadout of active augments, inventory items, or prepped casts during *phased* (turn-based) gameplay, you will *deplete* your [**GRACE**] score. You may change your actively equipped items without penalty during phased gameplay, but note that pulling items out of your pack to do so will still deplete your [**GRACE**].

You can change any part of your loadout without penalty during *open* (non-turn-based) gameplay however many times you like.

3.6 Languages

Languages may be modified to be setting specific in FRP, but there are 6 languages that are referred to in the base system listed in this section.

A character starts knowing Standard, and depending on your character's species may know one other language by default. Your character may learn a new language by investing 2XP.

- **Standard**– A common language spoken by most sentient creatures. A cultural relic of a vast fallen empire which used to rule the setting.
- **Leesong**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Avian species.
- **Chitter**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Weaver Species.
- **Wake**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Aquatic species.
- **Slewback**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Reptilian species.
- **Prineu**– A language that is part of the cultural heritage of the Homonid species.

The GM may add languages and dialects beyond these to their setting as they see fit

3.7 Skills

Skills are things your character has trained in which confer various benefits. You must invest in skills with XP in order to use them.
It costs:

- 1 XP for the first rank in a skill
- 2 XP for the second rank in a skill
- 3 XP for the third rank in a skill.

Each skill may only be listed once (with the exception of the “Familiarity” skill), and you may have a maximum of 3 ranks in any skill.

What follows are descriptions of all the skills your character can take.

- **Augment Mastery**– for each rank in augment mastery, you may increase your **[MAX AUGMENTS]** by one.
- **Marathon Caster**– for each rank in marathon caster, you may increase your **[MAX CAST ACTIVATIONS]** by one
- **Versatile Caster**– for each rank in versatile caster, you may increase your **[MAX PREPARED CASTS]** by one.
- **Robust**– you may take wounds up to **[RANKS]** in Robust without depleting any of your fundamentals. Once you exceed this number of wounds you will start depleting fundamentals as usual in response to sustaining a wound.
- **Porter**– for each rank in porter, you may increase your **[PACK Wt]** by 1.
- **Walking Armory**– for each rank in Walking Armory, you may increase your **[EQUIP Wt]** by 1.
- **Linguist**– Whenever you must roll for any sort of communication involving a language your character does not know, you may do so with **[RANKS]** additional advantage.
- **Familiarity with [topic]**– pick a topic your character is familiar with. The topic must be much more specific than "social," "martial," or "technical." Whenever your character is rolling in a situation relating to this topic, gain **[RANKS]** bonus dice to your roll. You may take this skill multiple times as long as the topic is unique for each listing.

Examples of topics for Familiarity:

- Unarmed combat
- A specific class of spaceships
- A specific type of magic
- A specific type of weapon
- A specific culture
- A specific technology

The GM of a game can decide if the topic your character has picked is specific enough for the Familiarity skill. If a topic you've already chosen seems too broad after a few sessions of play, the GM can ask you to narrow your topic. If a topic you've chosen seems too narrow after a few sessions of play, you may ask the GM to broaden your topic.

3.8 Character Building Overview section.

For convenience, this section is a consolidated step-by-step guide to building a character. You may follow along with the example character sheet at the end of this

1. Chose your Fundamentals. Your foundations (**[HEART]**, **[BODY]**, and **[MIND]**) should all sum up to 6. Your characteristics (**[PRECISION]**, **[STRENGTH]**, **[GRACE]**) should all sum up to 8. The minimum value

of any of these fundamentals is 1.

2. Choose a species. Apply any bonuses to talents by writing them in the corresponding box labeled with {+}. Take note of any species abilities.
3. Write “Standard” in your languages. If your species gives you another language by default, write this in your languages as well.
4. Set your [**MAX CASTS**] to your [**PRECISION**] score, and set your [**MAX PREP**] to your [**MIND**] score.
5. Set your [**EQUIP Wt**] to your [**BODY**] score, and set your [**PACK Wt**] to your [**STRENGTH**] score.
6. Set your [**MAX AUGMENTS**] to your [**HEART**] score.
7. Start with 12 XP. Invest as you see fit in various abilities, or save them for later.
8. Start with 1000 gold. Invest in equipment as you see fit, or save it for later.
9. Choose a number of casts less than or equal to your [**MAX PREP**] and write them in your list of prepped casts. Place corresponding cast focuses in the cast focus section of your Pack.
10. Choose a number of augments less than or equal to your [**MAX AUGMENTS**] and write them in your list of augments.
11. If you have taken the robust skill, you can put the number of skill ranks you have in robust in the smaller box of the “Wounds” section of the character sheet.
12. Discard items of your choice in your pack until the total weight of pack items is less than or equal to [**PACK Wt**].

Character Name

Species

XP

Archetype

Species Abilities

Languages

Used Ranks Bonus

☐ [MAX PREP]

Prepped Casts

☐/☐ [MAX CASTS]

Prepped Casts

Armor

[GRAB LIMBS]

[EQUIP WT]

Wt Resistance

Bonus

Implements

Wt

Implements

Wt

Augments

[MAX AUGMENTS]

[DISABLED]

[WOUNDS]

ROBUST

CHARACTERISTICS

[PRECISION]

[STRENGTH]

[GRACE]

[MIND]

MEMORY

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

INTELLECT

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

INSIGHT

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

[BODY]

DEXTERITY

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

FORTITUDE

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

ATHLETICS

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

[HEART]

PERCEPTION

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

WILL

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

CHARISMA

Species Aptitude

{+} {aa}

Cast Focuses

Wt

[GOLD]

[PACK WT]

Items

Wt

Items

Wt

STUDY



TINKER



PRACTICE



DEVELOP



TRAIN



ENHANCE



Skills

Ranks

Skills

Ranks

4 Gameplay

Gameplay in TRP is divided into *open* mode and *phased* mode.

4.1 Open mode

Unless the narrative of the game requires extended sequences of rapid action, it's best to keep the game in *open* mode.

Open mode consists of the GM describing a general setting, and the players asking questions to build on the setting and decide what to do. Whenever there's a questionable chance of success to something the players would like to do, the GM will ask them to make relevant rolls.

This is best illustrated with an example.

GM: As you enter the ruins, you notice the ground change beneath you, from soft dirt to sharp gravel. The sounds of wildlife grow eerily quiet.

Pillars of stone are arranged in a path to the temple, some of them are cracked and fallen. You see the mysterious door described by the pirates, but there's a pillar that has fallen over and is blocking it.

Alice: Huh. Can we see past the broken pillar?

GM: You can! The top half of the door is visible, but you can't see the inset for the key you found earlier.

Eve: I could move the pillar out of the way.

Bob: I could also try to worm my way past the pillar to reach the keyhole.

Eve: Oh! good point, maybe try that first.

Bob: I take the key and try to squeeze my way past the pillar.

GM: This requires grace of body. It's an extremely odd angle, so roll with {*dd2*}

ATHLETICS ROLL

Bob: R2a8{*dd2*} ⇒
R2a6 -  

Bob: Awww, so close.

GM: You try several times, Bob, but you just can't squeeze in the key.

(continued...)

(...continued)

Eve: Let me move it for you, Bob.
Could I lift the pillar up?

GM: Okay- That will require strength of body, and the pillar is incredibly heavy. I'd say it's nearly impossible to perform this task, and it has a risk of injury to body on failure. It would need a roll for  **FORTITUDE** with {*dd8*}.

Alice: I'd like to look for a broken piece of stone or something we could use as a wedge to make that easier. Doesn't seem right to risk getting injured before even starting this dungeon.

GM: Sure! That seems reasonable. Seems like Grace of Mind to find a clever way to use your surroundings to make this task easier. Roll me  **INSIGHT**.

INSIGHT ROLL

Alice: R3a5 -   

GM: Great. Alice you notice that one side of the pillar is resting on the stone base on top of a shard of rock. A strong enough person should be able to knock out that rock and let the pillar roll aside. I'll say this brings down the difficulty of the task to hard- requiring {*dd4*}. You still risk injury on failure.

Alice: I suggest pushing out the rock to Eve.

Eve: I'll take Alice's suggestion.

Bob: Wait! We should all be able to do this together. I can help Eve push that rock.

GM: Sure! Eve give me a  **FORTITUDE** roll, and Bob give me a helping roll.

FORTITUDE ROLL

Eve: R6a4{*dd4*} ⇒
R6a0 -      

Bob: R2a3{*dd4*} ⇒
R2d1 -  

GM: Wow! You both heave at the same time and manage to roll the pillar onto it's side so that there's more space near the door. Bob your earlier frustration with the pillar really comes out here and you help Eve bring it over the edge.

Note the back and forth between the GM and the players in this example. The GM poses a problem to the players- namely that there is a pillar blocking the keyhole to the door. The players propose various solutions to the problem, and can even add to the environment by asking

the GM about things that could plausibly exist.

As a GM, when a player suggests something, it behooves you to find something similar that could possibly work to keep the game going.

Below are some guidelines for assigning additional advantage and disadvantage based on the difficulty of the task:

Table 4a: Additional Advantage Guide

DIFFICULTY	ADDL ADV
Near impossible to fail	{aa8}
Very easy task	{aa6}
Easy task	{aa4}
Task with a few situational advantages	{aa2}
Average Difficulty	{aa0}
Task with a few situational disadvantages	{dd2}
Hard task	{dd4}
Very hard task	{dd6}
Near impossible task	{dd8}

4.1.1 Taking Damage

As the players explore the environment, dangers such as traps or hostile creatures or characters may deal damage to them. The number of wounds a player sustains is equal to the damage dealt.

Damage can be either elemental, physical, or direct.

For elemental and physical damage, armor reduces the amount of damage that a player sustains. Plain armor without resistance or bonus reduces amount of damage by the weight of the armor.

Armor can have elemental or physical resistance. Elemental resistance armor reduces elemental damage by an additional 1. Physical resistance armor reduces physical damage by an additional 1.

Armor may have a bonus which corre-

sponds to 1 of the 9 basic talents. When a character has armor with a bonus, this talent allows them to block with that armor. Roll the talent listed by the armor bonus and incoming damage is reduced additionally by your number of successes on the armor bonus roll.

Direct damage is not reduced by armor. A character taking direct damage will take a number of wounds equal to the damage.

Injuries are also not reduced by armor.

Incoming damage is also reduced by the amount of cover a character has, which is often only relevant in Phased mode.

4.1.2 Downtime

Downtime is a special part of *open* game-play where a character takes care of slower tasks after the action for the day calms down. Downtime tasks are tasks that would typically take very long segments of in-game time, and so are reserved for when the action calms down.

Downtime consists of the following for each character:

1. Perform downtime actions - the GM must grant a minimum of 2 downtime actions. They may grant an additional bonus downtime action as appropriate, and rarely may grant 2 bonus downtime actions.
 - If one of your actions is **not RECOVERATE**, deplete **one** Foundation of your choice (Mind, Body, Heart) **in addition** to **not** resetting your depleted fundamentals.
2. Choose character's loadout for the next day.

The possible downtime actions are listed below.

- **STUDY**– Roll  **MEMORY**. Increment your study counter by the number of successes you get. When your study counter hits 12 - you reset it to 0 and create a new wt 0 cast focus of your choice (not automatically prepped).
- **SCAVENGE**– Roll  **INTELLECT**. Gain scavenged loot of value equal to 100 gold times the number of successes you get. Ask your GM what loot you obtain.
- **TINKER**– Roll  **INSIGHT**. Increment your tinker counter by the number of successes you get. When your tinker counter hits 12 you may either
 - Create a new item of craft grade 1
 - Create an upgrade that would increase the craft grade of another item by 1
 - Increase the amount of grade of a previously created upgrade by 1.

Upgrades may be applied immediately or at any point during freeform gameplay. You do not need to finalize the properties of the upgrade until your final application of the upgrade.

- **PRACTICE**– Roll  **DEXTERITY**. Increment your practice counter by the number of successes you get. When your practice counter hits 12, reset it to 0, and you may increase the rank of a skill that has 1 rank to 2 ranks. This may be a skill on either your own character, or on any character that has been nearby who you could have been practicing with.
- **DEVELOP**– Roll  **FORTITUDE**. Increment your Development counter by the number of successes you get. When your Development counter hits 12, reset it to 0 and grant yourself or any other player character close to you 1 XP.
- **TRAIN**– Roll  **ATHLETICS**. Increment your Training counter by the number of successes you get. When your Training counter hits 12, reset it to 0 and you may add 1 rank to a Skill that has no ranks in it. This may be a skill on either your own character, or on any character that has been nearby for significant periods of time who you ostensibly could have been practicing with.
- **EXPLORE**– Roll  **PERCEPTION**. If successful, Roll from the exploration table to determine a new area that your character discovers. You may adjust your table roll by a number up to the number of successes you got on the exploration roll.
- **ENHANCE**– Roll  **WILL**. Increment your Enhance counter by the number of successes you get. When your Augmentation counter hits 12, reset it to 0 and either
 - Add a new augment to your character or any nearby willing character.
 - Replace an augment on a character (yours or any nearby willing) with a different augment
 - Replace two augments with an attunement on your own character or any nearby willing character.

(continued...)

(...continued)

- Replace an attunement with another attunement or two augments, on your own character or any nearby willing character. The affected character loses any XP invested in the original attunement.
- **SOCIALIZE**– Roll  **CHARISMA**. For each success on your roll, you may either
 - Obtain a piece of plot information from gossip or news.
 - Start a rumour that will reach a specific NPC your character is aware of.
 - Make an NPC who is negative towards your party neutral towards your party.
 - Make an NPC who is neutral towards your party positive towards your party.

You may not adjust the attitude of an NPC who is explicitly hostile towards your party.

- **SHOP**– Ask the GM if this action is available. Purchase equipment and sell equipment. By default, equipment sells for 50% of the price of new equipment. You may roll  **PERCEPTION** to find bargains and decrease the price of buying a piece of new equipment by 10% per success on your perception roll. You may roll  **CHARISMA** to sell your old equipment for higher prices and increase the price of selling a piece of equipment by 10% per success on your charisma roll.
- **CELEBRATE**– Ask the GM if this action is available. This action requires two or more player characters to perform this same action during the same downtime. The next day, all participating player characters will 1 bonus rank to their archetype.
- **RECUPERATE**– Consumes the equivalent of 1 ration. Your character eats and sleeps (if applicable) and tends to their wounds. Perform the following:
 1. Reset any depleted fundamentals.
 2. Clear all wounds
 3. Reset cast uses
 4. Reset loadout change uses
 5. Reset uses of an archetype
 6. Reset bonus ranks in an archetype.

4.2 Phased mode

When performing time sensitive tasks or entering contests or combat, the game enters phased mode.

The GM rotates through different phases where one party is on offense and

the other parties are on defense. The GM chooses which party starts on offense based on who initiated the combat.

Defenders choose their reactions first during a turn, and then offense chooses their actions. If one particular character initiated combat with action of any kind, that action occurs before the defenders

choose their reactions.

The players within a party may choose their actions and reactions in any order, and do not need to wait until one player has completed all possible actions before performing their own.

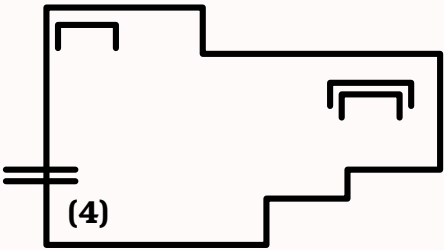
4.2.1 The Arena

When the game enters phased mode the GM must specify an arena. The arena rules are designed to be able to quickly generate unique scenarios.

An arena consists of 1 or more rooms. Each room contains

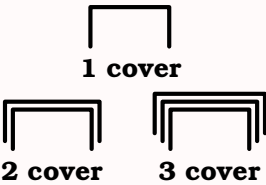
- 1 or more spaces
- 0 or more cover spots
- 1 or more connections to other rooms
- 0 or more exits from the arena

Figure 4a: Room Diagram Example



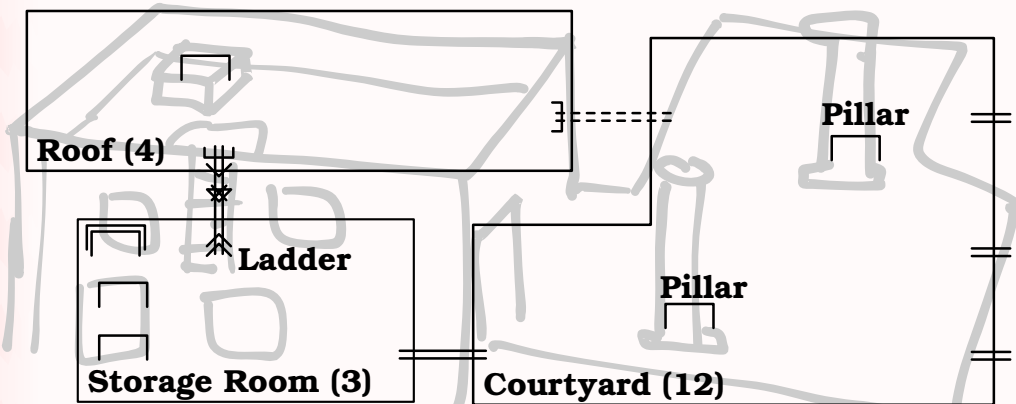
Rooms are shown by right-angled shapes around an area. The number of spaces in a room is indicated by a number in parentheses in a corner.

Figure 4b: Symbols for Cover Spots



You may optionally sketch the actual physical layout that you're trying to get the players to visualize as in the example that follows.

Figure 4c: An example schematic diagram of an arena



Characters have tokens or coins that represent them that can be moved from room to room, or placed on a cover spot, to indicate where they are physically.

A room can be entered even if it is at capacity, but at the end of each phase, if there are more characters than spaces in the room, the GM chooses characters that are not in covered spots to be pushed out of the room by the action until there are only as many characters in the room as there are spaces.

Characters in covered spots may remain in a room even if the room is over capacity.

It takes a movement action to get into or out of a cover spot. A cover spot can only be entered if it is unoccupied. Characters not in a cover spot move freely within the room without a move action.

A character behind cover has any incoming damage reduced by the amount of cover.

Connections are drawn between rooms with a double line. A connection which leads to open space rather than another room indicates an exit from the arena.

Below are some ways you can vary the connection in a diagram.

Table 4b: Connection Symbols

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION
	Plain connection that takes 1 movement to traverse.
	Visual only- provides line of sight, no traversal.
	1 extra move action to traverse in this direction. <i>N</i> arrows indicate <i>N</i> extra move actions are required.

(table continues...)

SYMBOL DESCRIPTION



1 cover from this room for line of sight. *N* stacked cover symbols indicate *N* cover.



A hazard is present when moving in this direction. If not intentionally moved in this direction, a character (or object) will take 1 damage. *N* concentric triangles indicate *N* damage.



A trap is present when traversing this connector. *N* concentric squares around this symbol indicate *N* damage.

The trap symbol may also be placed in a room.

Figure 4d: Symbols for Traps



**1 damage
trap**



**2 damage
trap**



**3 damage
trap**

Traps outside a connector act like cover spaces- they require a movement to step into, and on moving into a trap, they deal the amount of damage indicated. The type of damage dealt depends on the type of trap. A character encountering a trap must roll  **DEXTERITY**. The damage a trap deals is reduced by the number of successes on the Dexterity roll.

Armor does protect against trap dam-

age unless the trap deals direct damage.

Note that if your players are creative with their surroundings, you may end up adding, changing, or removing rooms, connections, hazards, and traps as the turn-based gameplay progresses!

The fastest way to generate an arena is collaboratively—when an arena is needed, the GM should describe the rooms and connectors, and the players should help draw what the GM is describing.

4.2.2 Ranges

Every action a character can perform has a range.

- **Self**— Only affects the character performing the action
- **Touch**— Affects any one target in the same room as the character
- **Connected**— Affects any one target within the same room as the character, or any adjacent rooms connected directly to the current room.
- **Line-of-sight**— Affects any one target the character has line-of-sight to.
- **Room**— Affects all objects and characters within the room.
- **Area**— Affects all objects and characters in this room and all connected rooms
- **Arena**— Affects all objects and characters within the arena.
- **Awareness**— Affects any one target the character is presently aware of via any of their senses.

Ranges are particularly relevant in phased mode, but may be applicable in other scenarios as well.

4.2.3 Offense

Each character can take 3 offensive actions during each offensive phase.

They may choose freely from any offensive actions available to them and perform one of the options multiple times if they want.

Your possible actions are:

- Interact
- Apply talent
- Move
- Attack
- Obstruct
- Use other ability or item that is labeled “as an action” or “as an offensive action”

A description of each of these options follows:

- **Interact** *Touch range*– Flip a switch, pull a lever, pick up an object, drop an object, or perform any other interaction that does not require a talent roll.
- **Apply Talent** *Touch range*– Directly apply one of the character's talents to any target within the room.
- **Move** *Self range*– Move this character. Typically one move action is required to move from one room to another, but depending on the arena, additional movement may be needed.
- **Attack**– Attack, either using a tool/weapon, or your body.

When taking the attack action, you may make as many attacks as it takes to use all your **[GRAB LIMBS]** (the number of prehensile limbs your character has). Some attacks may use up more than one of your limbs to use. Your options are:

- **Weapon Attack**– for each attack action, a character may only attack once with each weapon they have currently equipped. Weapons have an associated talent to use them, and weapons have a minimum or maximum number of limbs you may use to attack.

A weapon attack roll involves rolling the associated talent, with bonus dice equal to the number of limbs used to attack.

The number of successes on your roll indicates the amount of damage you do, and the type of damage is dependent on the weapon.

- **Barehanded Attack** *Touch range*– Choose a number of limbs you are going to make a single attack with. Roll $\{\{\{\text{FORTITUDE}\} + [\text{LIMBS}]\}$.

The number of successes on your roll indicates the amount of physical damage you do.

- **Grapple** *Touch range*– Involves any maneuver meant to move another character against their will. This involves a roll contest where a character rolls $\{\{\{\text{ATHLETICS}\}\}$ and the target contests with $\{\{\{\text{FORTITUDE}\}\}$. A character within cover cannot initiate a grapple, but a character outside cover may initiate a grapple with a character within cover.

If you win the contest, you may force the target to make a single move action of your choice.

Additional forced movement requires additional grapple actions.

- **Disable** *Touch range*– Impair another character from accessing their augments for the rest of phased mode. This could involve attacking a pressure point or critical point meant to prevent the flow of energy to a character's augments.

The initiating character rolls $\{\{\{\text{DEXTERITY}\}\}$ and the target contests with $\{\{\{\text{FORTITUDE}\}\}$.

If you win the contest, the target's **[MAX AUGMENTS]** is temporarily reduced by 1 and they must choose augments to temporarily disable until they are below their new **[MAX AUGMENTS]**. Their **[MAX AUGMENTS]** is restored to normal as soon as Phased mode ends.

4.2.4 Defense

When you are defending, each character in the defending party must choose one reaction.

Your possible reactions are:

- Protect
- Retaliate
- Obstruct
- Dodge
- Use other ability or item that is labeled "as a defensive reaction"

For each of these, you must also specify your reaction trigger. Your choices of trigger are:

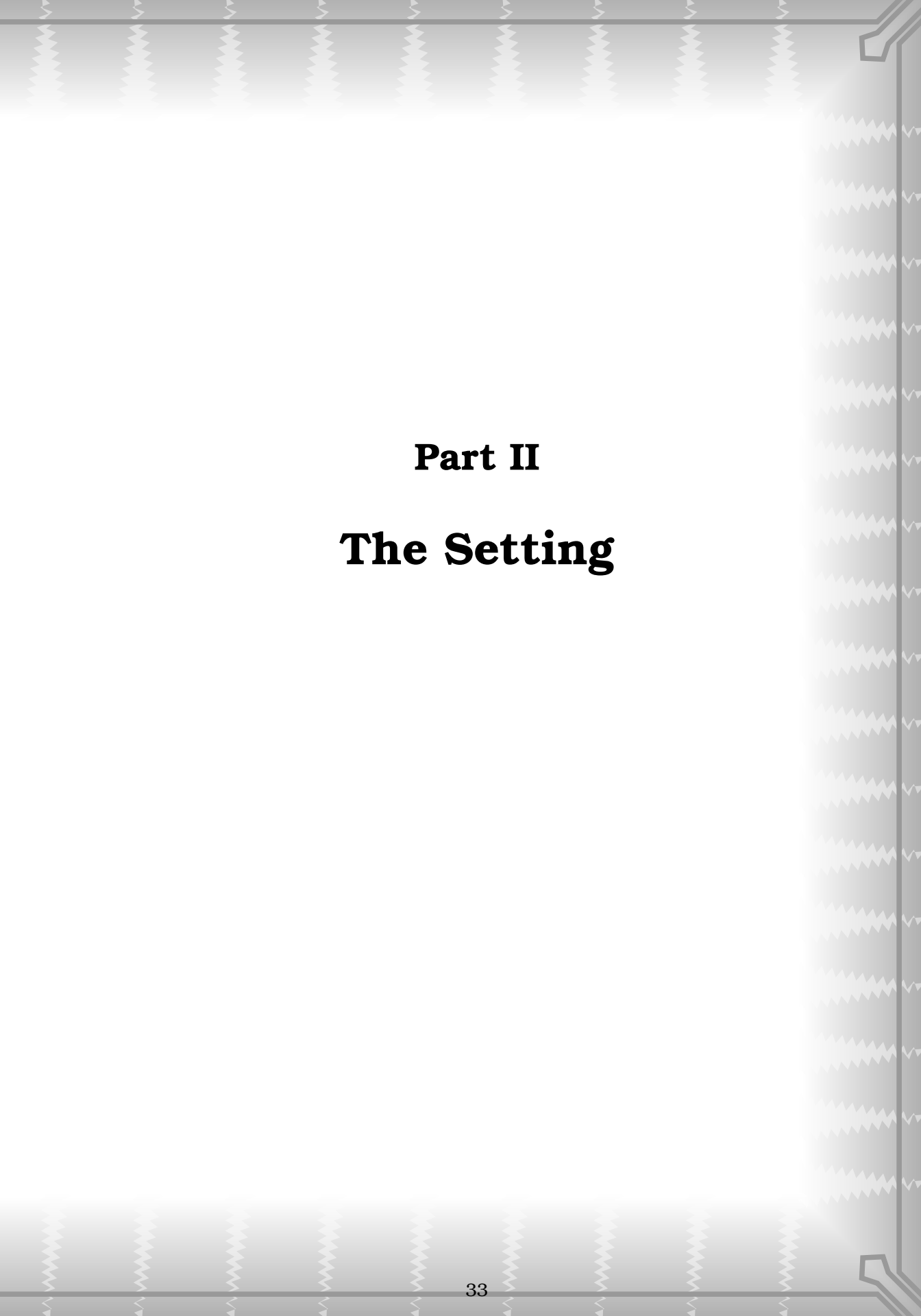
- the start of the phase
- an action taken targeting another character
- an action taken targeting your character
- an action taken by another character
- a character entering a room
- a character exiting a room

A description of each of the options follows:

- **Protect**– chose any one character or object within the same zone as you. Once triggered, for the rest of this turn any time an action is taken against the character or object you are protecting, you may contest your Athletics against the initiating character's roll to hit. If successful, the action is made to target you instead of its initial target.
- **Retaliate**– you may take one non-movement offensive action (as in the offense phase) in response to the trigger.
- **Obstruct**– In response to the trigger, you block one connector. You must be forced to make a Move action or be rendered incapacitated before anyone else can travel through that connector. This is generally indicated by placing your character token on top of the connector on the side of the room.
- **Dodge**– you may take one movement action in response to the trigger. If the trigger would incur damage to you, you may contest your Dexterity against the initiating character's roll to hit. If successful, you additionally avoid the damage in addition to taking a movement action.

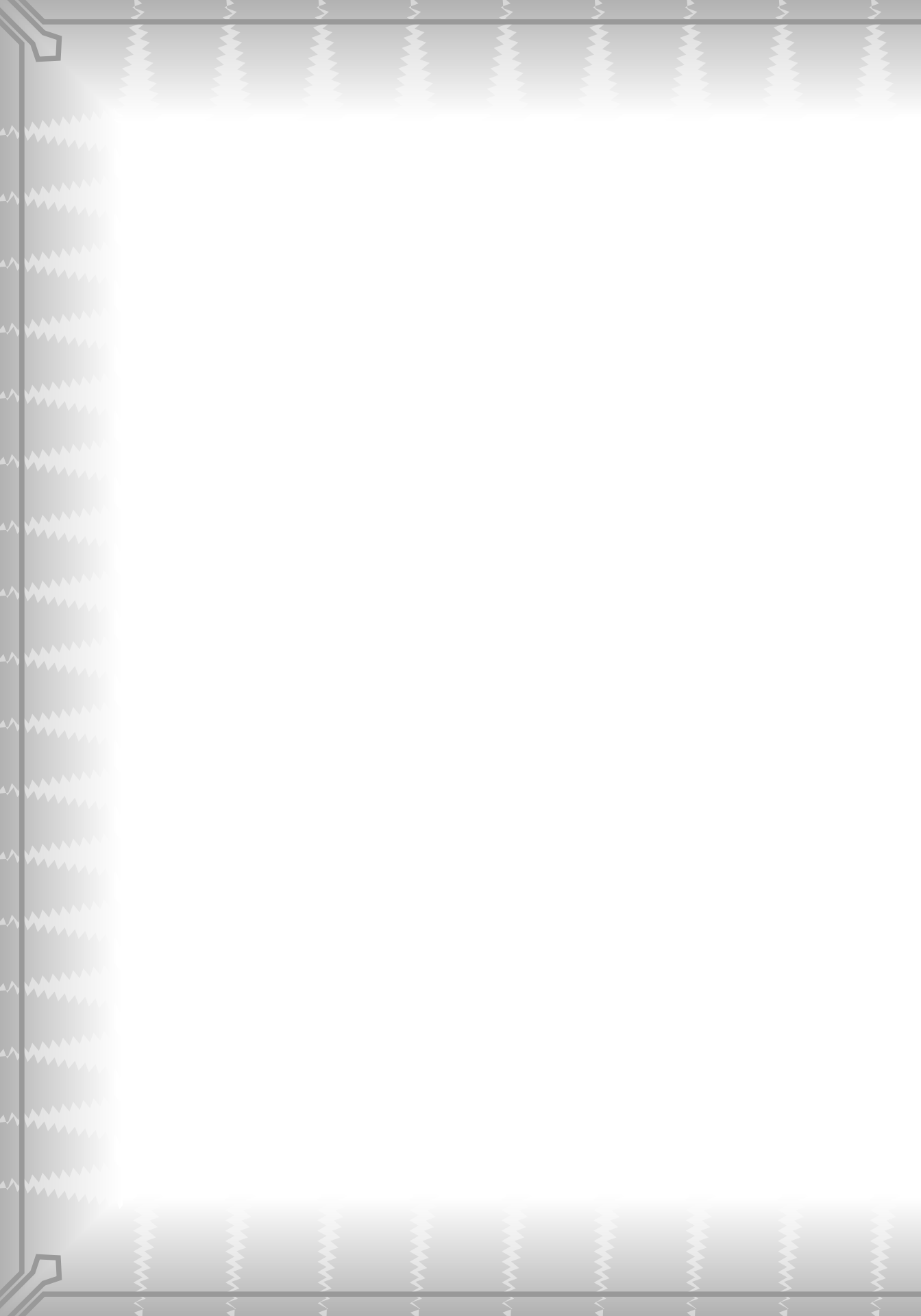
On a tabletop- you have the choice of sharing your defensive action with the

GM or of writing it on a card and turning it face down



Part II

The Setting



Overview of the Gamma Nebula

Gamma Nebula is a futuristic setting in another universe where advanced magic has enabled space exploration. The physics and the rules of the Gamma Nebula universe are very different to our own. Gamma Nebula has its own cosmology, history, and cultures, but a Game Master using the setting is encouraged to invent their own.

This book will lay out a framework of the galaxy and the way it works, but the details are left up to the Game Master and players, who may improvisationally create planets and peoples.

It's a big galaxy out there, with surprises and mysteries both ancient and new.

5.1 A brief history

The Gamma Nebula setting takes place in a galaxy called the Great Spiral. There are currently 20 known inhabited worlds in the great spiral governed by the Galactic Alliance, and linked through Fey Space by Fey Corridors.

More than 20,000 years ago, a flourishing galactic civilization of more than 2000 worlds was formed, led by a technologically advanced species known as the Dragons. The Dragons built the Fey Corridor network. Numerous sentient species lived under the rule of the dragons and used the Fey Corridor network for communication and trade. This period of time is referred to as the “Golden Age” or “Draconic Age.”

The majority of details of this civi-

lization were lost during the Spiral War 8,000 years ago. Dragons as a species were driven to extinction during the Spiral War.

All Fey Corridors were unusable for the first 1000 years after the Spiral War, and many Fey Corridor openings were completely destroyed or became permanently inoperable. Vast amounts of knowledge and technology were lost during that time, referred to as the Dark Ages.

Gradually, in the ruins of Draconic civilization, the remaining sentient races rebuilt. The first race to establish interstellar travel after the Spiral War were the Wyrmlin, who had access to the most undamaged Dragon technology.

Over the next 3000 years, other civilizations have risen up and joined galactic civilization at large. After some difficult periods of conflict between various governments, the modern Galactic Alliance was established almost 1000 years ago, and has enjoyed political and economic stability for a millenium. Everything that could be recovered from the Golden Age was thought to already be recovered.

But now, new technology has been discovered that enables the operation of long dead Fey Corridors. Hopeful governments and corporations have sponsored thousands of artifact hunters—hopeful explorers looking to investigate long-lost worlds for technology, information, and power from ages past.

Your players are in this galaxy of new opportunities, and it is up to them to decide what to do.

The Physics of Gamma Nebula

While the Gamma Nebula Universe looks and acts much like ours on first glance, the underlying rules of reality are very different.

Everything in the universe consists of either *matter* or *magic*. Matter is all physical objects in the world around the characters. Magic is the energy that these objects use to move and interact with each other.

All Matter and Magic is classified into different *elements*. In general it is easier to convert between matter and magic of the same element than it is to go between elements. There are typically only very few matter forms of an element, and infinitely many magic forms of an element. Matter forms of an element are completely stable and do not change except with external influence. Magic forms of an element may change over time without external influence.

The smallest particle of matter in an object is a molecule of a certain element. All but the simplest elements have multiple types of possible molecules of matter.

For the mathematically minded reader- arcanists in the Gamma Nebula Universe have discovered that the elements of the world correspond to the knots of mathematical knot theory. Each element corresponds to knots with a certain number of crossings. Matter forms of an element are prime knots.

6.1 Elements

6.1.1 Base Element

The simplest element that any element can be degraded to is *Essentia*. *Essentia* is both matter and magic in one form- there is no distinguishing between matter and magic for *essentia*.

Essentia suffuses the entire universe.
Element 0

6.1.2 The Motive Elements

Gravity and Levity are the motive elements. They are both unique in that there are no matter forms of this element, only a single magic form for Gravity and a single magic form for Levity.

All matter and magic higher than *essentia* radiate gravity and levity, and gravity and levity interact with all matter and all magic.

Element 1 and 2

6.1.3 Transformative Elements

The transformative elements both only have one matter form and a handful of magical forms.

- Fire - 3
- Lightning -4

Fire magic and lightning magic is commonly present in some respect in any setting, and most of the elements higher than these two radiate magical forms of these elements in appropriate settings.

Because there is only one matter form of each of these elements, stable fire and lightning are actually fairly uncommon except in *stars*.

6.1.4 Primary Elements

- Air -5
- Water -6
- Metal -7 - gold isoform 1 of metal, is a very unique form of metal which is hard to produce, and very easy to detect if it is pure.
- Earth -8

6.1.5 Noble Elements

The noble elements are essential for life as we know it, and some form of these elements is present at least in small quantities in all living organisms. There

are many stable forms of these elements which account for much of the complexity of living organisms.

- Anima -9
- Bone -10
- Acid -11
- Plasm -12
- Blood -13

6.1.6 Higher Elements

Higher elements than element 13 exist but in numerous and multiple forms which are still being studied. Many of the rarer substances in the universe are forms of higher elements.

Higher elements are left more flexible so that the GM and players may improvise what they may be.

Races

Hi hi hiiiiiii

Here is the list of RAAACES. they aren't RACIST they are just RACES. YEEEEEEAH.

Species provide either of

- $\{+2\}$ to two different talents
- $\{+2\}$ to one talent and $\{+1\}$ to two different talents.
- $\{+3\}$ to one talent

7.1 Wyrmlinkin

The wyrmlinkin are the most populous race in the galaxy (though by themselves they do not comprise a majority of sentients). They have many dragon-like qualities, including their scales, their elemental breath, and their hatching from warm incubated eggs. It is a common belief among the wyrmlinkin that they carry the blood of the ancient dragons within them because of these similarities.

The wyrmlinkin have many names for themselves, the most common being “shell-born” – referring to their hatching from eggs which is uncommon among sentient races. Other common aliases include “of the holy breath” and “chosen of the dragons,” but these days these phrases are typically only heard among groups entrenched in an attitude of wyrmlinkin superiority over other races.

Appearance

Prehensile Limbs

Wyrmlinkin are of humanoid form with a non-prehensile tail.

[**GRAB LIMBS**] is 2.

Languages

- Standard

Species Bonuses

- {+2}  **INTELLECT**
- {+2}  **CHARISMA**

Species Abilities

- **Wyrmling Breath**– Choose one of the *transformative elements* (Fire or lightning). As an action you may produce this element from your mouth in a controlled fashion. If using this to craft or create something, relevant talent checks must still be made. During *phased* mode, you may use this to fill a room temporarily with the element of your choice as a Room Range attack, using Fortitude for your attack roll.
- **Draconic Upbringing**– Start with 1 rank in the skill **FAMILIAR WITH DRAGON CULTURE** at the creation of your character before investing any experience. If this does not apply to the setting you are using this character in, then you may replace this with a different **FAMILIAR** skill at the discretion of the GM.

7.2 Kobolds

Kobolds look superficially similar to the wyrmkin, but have much smaller proportions and have a more raptor-like stature. Unlike the wyrmkin, kobolds have live births rather than hatching from incubated eggs. More insular wyrmkin tend to look down on kobolds as a parody of their race. Historically, kobold communities have faced considerable prejudice from wyrmkin society.

Appearance

Kobolds are covered with scales like many of the reptilian races, but may also have small amounts of featherlike softer scales in some areas of their bodies. Kobold scale colors tend to be either shades of orange, brown, blue, or green, and may have spotted and striped patterns.

Prehensile Limbs

Kobolds are bipedal with two prehensile arms and a prehensile tail.

[**GRAB LIMBS**] is 3.

Languages

- Standard
- Slewback

Species Bonuses

- {+1}  **MEMORY**
- {+2}  **INSIGHT**
- {+1}  **DEXTERITY**

Species Abilities

- **Pack Instinct**– During offensive phased mode, making any sort of helping roll does not consume an action. If helping make a cast or any other consumable ability, a kobold still consumes a cast use or the consumable resource.

7.3 Carcinids

Carcinids are large, crab-like sentient beings that live in all corners of the galaxy. Many independent communities of carcinids survived the Spiral War in many different.

Most carcinids do not have anything that could be denoted a biological sex. Most carcinids may reproduce by laying eggs which may contain just their own genetic material, or include that of a co-parent.

Appearance

Carcinids have a hard outer carapace around a scaffolding they use as an exoskeleton. They are of smaller stature than most sentients. There are many possible colorations and patterns for a carcinid's carapace.

Prehensile Limbs

Carcinids have 10 limbs they can walk on, 5 of which are free for manipulation of objects at any given time.

[**GRAB LIMBS**] is 5

Languages

Carcinids are unable to learn to speak any language besides chitter without the use of assistive devices or spells due to the shape of their mouthparts.

- Standard (limited)
- Chitter

Species Bonuses

- {+2}  **DEXTERITY**
- {+2}  **INSIGHT**

Species Abilities

-

7.4 Automa

Automa are living machines from the Golden Age. All of them were shutdown by the same weapon that destroyed the fey corridor network. Old broken down automa are often found in Golden Age ruins, and occasionally may be in a state where they may be restored to operation. Once restored to operation, they are able to heal from injuries and

Automa tend to have very degraded and vague memories of their time before the Spiral War, but this is still considered valuable information by many artifact hunters.

Appearance

Prehensile Limbs

Automa come in various shapes and have a minimum of 2 prehensile limbs. They may have up to 2 additional prehensile limbs determined by the **CONFIGURABLE BODY** species ability.

Languages

- Standard

Species Bonuses

- {+2}  **INTELLECT** - during the **RECUPERATE** action, you can forego this species bonus to have one additional prehensile limb
- {+2}  **FORTITUDE** - during the **RECUPERATE** action, you can forego this species bonus to have one additional prehensile limb

Species Abilities

- **Essentia Essentials**– Automa do not need to eat or breathe. They appear to draw on the same power that Fey Corridors draw on. When taking the **RECUPERATE** downtime action, Automa do not consume rations. Additionally they are unaffected by hostile atmospheres or a lack of atmosphere.
- **Configurable body**– Whenever you take the **RECUPERATE** downtime action, you may add up to 2 additional [**GRAB LIMBS**] by forgoing your Species bonuses.

Each Species bonus you forgo gives you 1 additional Grab Limb.

-

7.5 Species template

Appearance

Prehensile Limbs

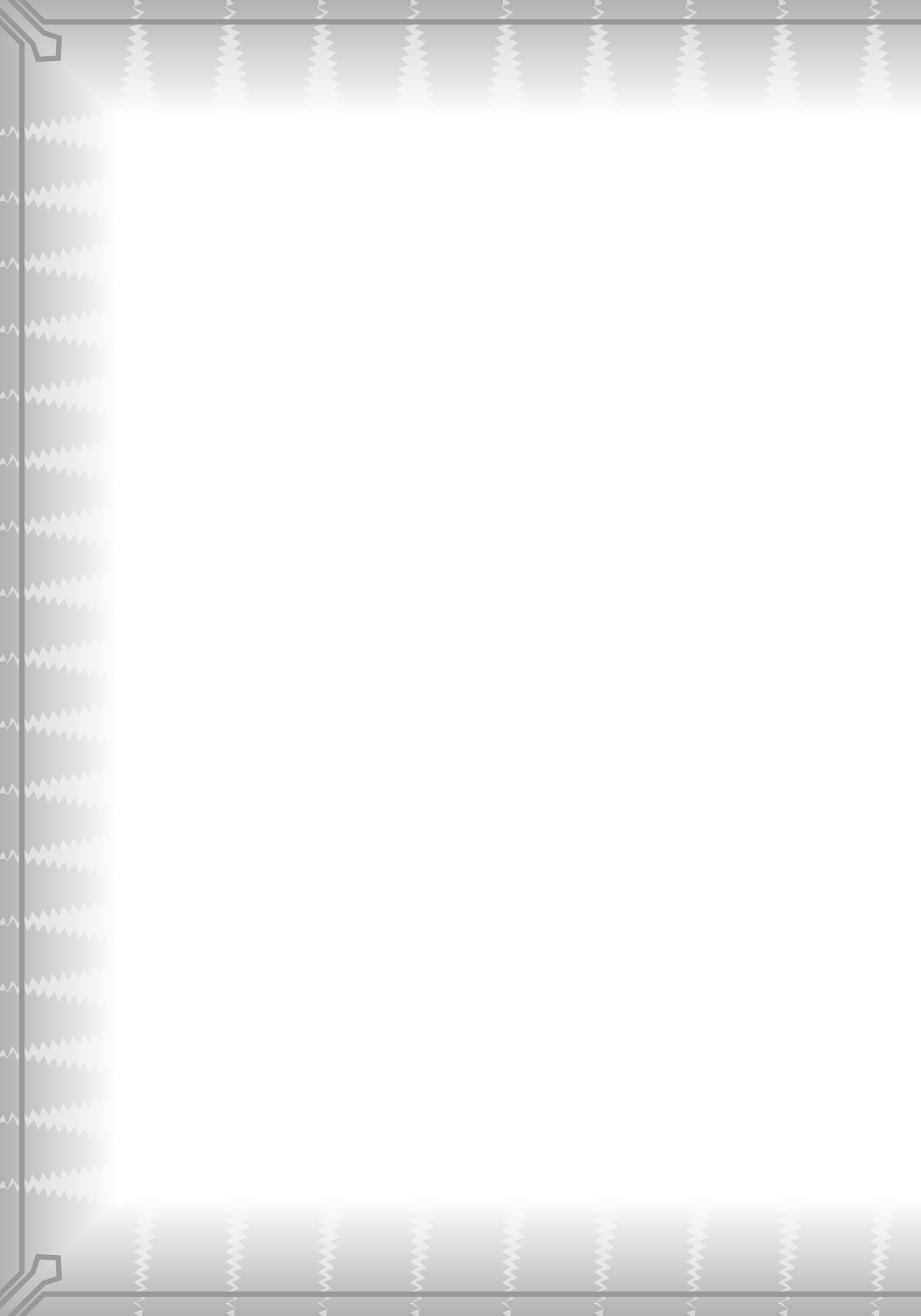
Languages

Species Bonuses

Species Abilities

Part III

Appendices



Appendix: Mathematical Formulas

For the probability of success for a roll $RXaY$:

$$[\text{PROBABILITY}] = \begin{cases} \text{if } Y \geq 12, & 100\% \\ \text{if } 12 > Y > 0, & 1 - \left(\frac{12 - Y}{12}\right)^X \\ \text{if } Y = 0, & 1 - \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^X \\ \text{if } 0 > Y \geq -X, & \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^{(-Y-1)} - \left(\frac{11}{12}\right)^X \times \left(\frac{10}{11}\right)^{(-Y-1)} \\ \text{if } -X > Y, & 0\% \end{cases} \quad (\text{Appendix:.1})$$

Appendix: List of Figures

3a	: Talents you can proxy at -2a	14
3b	: Talents you can proxy at -4a	14
4a	: Room Diagram Example	28
4b	: Symbols for Cover Spots	28
4c	: An example schematic diagram of an arena	28
4d	: Symbols for Traps	29

Appendix: List of Tables

2a	: Advantage Examples	5
2b	: Disadvantage Examples	6
2c	: Roll Success Probability	6
3a	: Fundamental Talents	11
4a	: Additional Advantage Guide	25
4b	: Connection Symbols	29

Appendix: Alphabetical Index

A

Additional Advantage7
Additional Disadvantage7
Advantage5

C

Characteristic11

D

Die Bonus7
Die Penalty7
Disadvantage6

F

Foundation11

G

Game Master5
Group Roll7
 Example7
Group Roll Contest9

H

Helping Roll9
 Example9

N

NPC11

P

PC11
Player5

R

Roll Contest8
 Example8
Roll notation5

T

Talent11
 Examples12